Updated: 10/31/2026

JING TAO

Jing.Tao@UTDallas.edu ◇ Personal Website ◇ LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Digital Politics; AI Governance; Public Opinion and Political Trust; Cybersecurity and Misinformation; Causal Inference and Computational Social Science

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science Expected May 2027
The University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX
Dissertation: *The Political Consequences of Emerging Technologies: Trust, AI Safety, and AI Governance — Evidence from Cyber Espionage, AI Liability, and National AI Strategies*
Committee: Pengfei Zhang and Patrick T. Brandt (Co-Chairs), Jonathan Pinckney, Natalia Lamberova

M.S. in Social Data Analytics and Research Expected December 2026
The University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX

M.A. in International Studies August 2020
Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea
Selected as Graduate Representative

Exchange Student in International Studies August 2019 – January 2020
Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey, Monterey, CA

B.A. in Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language July 2016
Kunming University of Science and Technology, Kunming, China

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Revise and Resubmit

Pengfei Zhang, Humza Khan, and **Jing Tao**. "The Deterrence Effect of the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime Revisited: Empirical Findings and Lessons for the UN Convention." *R&R at Journal of Cyber Policy.*

Under Review

Jing Tao. "When Cyber Espionage Becomes Public: Disclosure and Institutional Confidence across Political Regimes." *Under review at Contemporary Politics.*

Working Papers

Jing Tao. "From Ambition to Action: National AI Strategies and Downstream Policymaking."

Jing Tao. "Holding AI Liable? An Experimental Study of Public Opinion on AI Safety."

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND PRESENTATIONS

"From Ambition to Action: National AI Strategies and Downstream Policymaking."
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference, 2026.

"When Cyber Espionage Goes Public: Disclosure Shocks and Citizen Confidence in Institutions."
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, 2026.

"Fiscal Centralization and Local Public Service in China."
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference, 2026. *Accepted for presentation; not presented.*

"Arrests, Tunnels, and Trump: The Politics of Border Security in the 2024 Election."
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, 2025.

COMPUTATIONAL PROJECTS

Cyber Operations Incident Database (COID) Spring 2026
Designed and implemented a normalized relational database of state-sponsored cyber operations using the CFR Cyber Operations Tracker. Built the relational schema, ETL pipeline, and analytical query infrastructure using PostgreSQL, SQL, Python, pandas, and psycopg2. *GitHub Repository*

The Cyber Conflict Globe: Dynamic 3D Visualization of State-Linked Operations Fall 2025
Project Lead
Conceived and led the project from idea development to final product. Designed the overall research and visualization architecture, coordinated the data workflow, and independently developed the full JavaScript implementation for the interactive 3D globe, automatic rotation, temporal animation, and user controls using the ArcGIS API for JavaScript. *Video Demo*

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Editorial Assistant, *Political Analysis* Fall 2026 – Present
Editor-in-Chief: Patrick T. Brandt
Support manuscript processing, reviewer identification, and computational replication review.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Misinformation and Fact-Checking Experiment Summer 2025
Research Assistant; Faculty PI: Pengfei Zhang
Analyzed experimental data on misinformation and fact-checking interventions; extended analyses across treatment conditions, examined response time and accuracy, and conducted mixed-effects logistic regression and treatment-group comparisons.

DMCA Takedown Notice Coding Project Summer 2024
Research Assistant; Faculty PI: Pengfei Zhang
Developed a coding framework and codebook for Lumen Database DMCA takedown notices, operationalizing notice characteristics, statutory compliance, sender and target attributes, and platform responses.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

GOVT 2306: State and Local Government Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant

PPPE 6353 / ECON 6362: Industry, Technology, and Science Policy Spring 2026

PSCI / PPOL / ECON 4325: Digital Economics and the Law Spring 2026

PPPE / PSCI 6303: Cyber Security Policy Fall 2025

EPPS 6313: Introduction to Quantitative Methods Fall 2025

GOVT 2305: American National Government Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

GOVT 2306: State and Local Government Fall 2024

PSCI 3350: Comparative Politics Spring 2024

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS & CERTIFICATIONS

Graduate Teaching Certificate, The University of Texas at Dallas 2025

Brian J. L. Berry Scholar, The University of Texas at Dallas 2023–Present

Academic Scholarship, Chung-Ang University 2018–2020

First-Class Scholarship, Kunming University of Science and Technology 2016

Certificate of Accreditation in Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language 2015

National Computer Rank Examination – MS Office Advanced Applications 2015

SKILLS

Programming & Statistical Software: R, Python, Stata, SQL, JavaScript

Data & Computational Tools: PostgreSQL, ArcGIS, Git/GitHub, LaTeX

Quantitative & Computational Methods: Causal Inference, Survey Experiments, Conjoint Analysis, Panel Data Methods, Matching and Weighting, API-Based Data Collection, LLM-Assisted Text Coding

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Korean (Conversational)

REFERENCES

Pengfei Zhang
Assistant Professor
School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences
The University of Texas at Dallas
Pengfei.Zhang@utdallas.edu

Patrick T. Brandt
Professor
School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences
The University of Texas at Dallas
pbrandt@utdallas.edu

Jonathan Pinckney
Associate Professor
School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences
The University of Texas at Dallas
Jonathan.Pinckney@UTDallas.edu

Natalia Lamberova
Assistant Professor
School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences
The University of Texas at Dallas
Natalia.Lamberova@UTDallas.edu